

SI XU

Tel: (+44) 07469187560 | ✉ si.xu.20@ucl.ac.uk |  
30 Gordon Street, London, WC1H 0QB, United Kingdom

EDUCATION

University College London, London, UK

PhD Candidate

MRes in Economics

Sep 2021 - present

Sep 2020 - Sep 2021

Duke University, Durham, NC, US

Master of Arts in Economics

Aug 2018 - May 2020

Central University of Finance and Economics, Beijing, China

Bachelor in Economics

Sep 2014 - June 2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary: Labor Economics, Economics of Ageing

Secondary: Public Policy

JOB MARKET PAPER

Employment Persistence after Raising Pensionable Age: Evidence from Japan

(with Saisawat Samutpradit)

Abstract: This paper studies how raising the pension eligibility age affects retirement behavior in Japan, a context with distinctive institutional settings: workers need to re-sign contracts at age 60 to continue employment and firms are legally obligated to offer re-employment until age 65, normally under altered conditions. Using administrative tax data, we examine a reform that increased the eligibility age for Earnings-Related Benefits (ERB) from 60 to 61. Notably, the reform not only kept workers in the labor force but also shifted workers into new employment contracts. The reform increased employment by approximately 5 percentage points, and strikingly different from other contexts, the effects persisted beyond age 61. The reform induced roughly 60 percent of individuals who would have exited employment to work approximately three additional years on average. Moreover, we found homogeneous employment effects for younger affected cohorts who faced two-year delay in ERB, suggesting that firm practices and labor market regulations may jointly shape the responses to the pension reform. Furthermore, we found that lower earners were more likely to stay with their employers at age 59, while higher earners tended to switch firms. The results imply that policies to prolong employment of elderly workers beyond the pensionable age should both address demand-side constraints and encourage workers to explore new job arrangements at late ages.

OTHER WORK IN PROGRESS

Old-age Pension Earnings Test and Labor Supply of Elderly Men: Evidence from Residential Tax Records in Japan *(with Ayako Kondo & Saisawat Samutpradit)*

Labor Market Outcomes of Older Workers Across the Business Cycle *(with Hyejin Ku)*

OTHER AFFILIATIONS

Centre for Research and Analysis of Migration (CReAM)

Research Officer

Sep 2021 - Present

Center for Research and Education in Program Evaluation, University of Tokyo

Visiting researcher

March 2024 - Present

Rockwool Foundation Berlin

Research Affiliate

June 2025 - Present

TEACHING

University College London, Department of Economics

Postgraduate Teaching Assistant mentors

Sep 2025 - Present

ECON0056 Economics of Education

Jan 2023 - Present

ECON0002/0095 Economics

Oct 2021 - May 2022

ECON0009 Introduction to Economic Thinking

Jan 2023 - March 2024

Duke University, Department of Economics

Selected Topics in Economics: Microeconometric tools

Jan 2020 - May 2020

Duke University, Fuqua Business School

Quantitative Business Analysis

July 2019 - Aug 2019

Central University of Finance and Economics, Department of Economics

Intermediate Macroeconomics

2015

PRE-PHD RESEARCH

Duke University, US

Research Assistant to Professor Marjorie B. McElroy

June 2019 - April 2020

Research Assistant to Assistant Professor Ines Black

June 2019 - Sep 2019

Independent Study with Prof. Arnaud Maurel

Aug 2019 - Nov 2019

Central University of Finance and Economics, Beijing, China

Research Assistant to Associate Professor Chuanchuan Zhang

Sep 2016 - June 2018

Research Assistant to Professor Binkai Chen

Sep 2015 - Sep 2016

CONFERENCE/WORKSHOP/PRESENTATIONS

2025

CReAM Spring workshop & Brown Bag seminar | University College London

ENTER seminar | Tilburg University

Workshop on the Economics of Aging | Rockwool Foundation Berlin

OLS seminar | University of Osaka

ENTER Jamboree Conference | Stockholm School of Economics

CEPR Economics Job Market Bootcamp

Retirement Sector Seminar | Institute for Fiscal Studies

CEPR Summer Conference: The Economics of Longevity & Ageing*

RFBerlin-CReAM Summer Workshop

2024

Applied Micro PhD Research Day | University College London

CReAM Brown Bag Seminar | University College London

2023

Asian and Australasian Society of Labor Economics (AASLE) Conference, Taipei

2022

CReAM 20th Anniversary Workshop on Topics in Labour Economics

* Invited to attend without presenting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CReAM – Co-organizer for Brown Bag seminars | London | *2024 - Present*

Accenture (China) Co., Ltd. – Business Analysis Intern | Beijing | *April - July 2018*

Prudential Hong Kong – Financial management Intern | Hong Kong | *Jan - Feb 2016*

Tsinghua University Schwarzman College – Fundraising Intern | Beijing | *July 2017 - Feb 2018*

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2020-Present University College London PhD Studentship

2019-2020 M.A. Merit Scholar Award

2017 Meritorious Prize for Mathematical Contest in Modeling (top 10-15%)

2014-2018 National Soong Ching Ling Development Foundation “Jingshu Ping Scholarship” (top 1%)

Dean’s list for “Outstanding Achievement Award” (top 4%)

Scholarship for Academic Excellence and Comprehensive Development (top 4%)

OTHER SKILLS

Analysis Stata, Matlab, R, MSQL, Latex, HTML

Certificate Association of Chartered Certified Accountants (Intermediate level, F1-F9)

Sports Rock climbing (V5), Half-marathon

REFERENCES

Professor Hyejin Ku

University College London

`h.ku@ucl.ac.uk`

Professor Christian Dustmann

University College London

`c.dustmann@ucl.ac.uk`

Professor Attila Lindner

University College London

`a.lindner@ucl.ac.uk`

Professor Uta Schönberg

The University of Hong Kong

`schoenbe@hku.hk`